AWESOME CYBER SECURITY HEAVEN · REALM DOSSIER · 2026 EDITION

The Cartographers

Recon, OSINT & Attack-Surface Mapping Tools

48	328,131	90%	42
FREE TOOLS	COMBINED STARS	ON GITHUB	ACTIVE IN 2026

48 tools · ← Back to the main list · Data verified **2026-10-23** (re-verified monthly)

CURATOR'S NOTES

The mapping layer of offensive work — subdomain enumeration, certificate transparency, DNS archaeology and attack-surface diffing. The projectdiscovery suite lives here, alongside the classic recon one-liners every bounty hunter memorizes.

MAINTENANCE SNAPSHOT (2026-10-23)

- **Active in the last 30 days:** 28 of 41 tracked GitHub repos (68%)
- **Quiet classics (no push in 12+ months, still listed):** VHostScan
- **Earliest entries:** dnsrecon (2010), theHarvester (2011), dirsearch (2013)

Part of Awesome Cyber Security Heaven — 519 curated free tools across 14 realms

FLAGSHIP PICKS — THE HEAVYWEIGHTS

TOOL	★STARS	CREATED	LAST PUSH	WHAT IT DOES
sherlock	94.7k	2018	2026-10-22 ✓	Hunt down social media accounts by username across social networks
GHunt	19.7k	2020	2026-04-10	Offensive Google framework.
theHarvester	18k	2011	2026-10-20 ✓	E-mails, subdomains and names Harvester - OSINT
katana	17.7k	2021	2026-10-22 ✓	A next-generation crawling and spidering framework.
ffuf	16.9k	2018	2026-09-26 ✓	Fast web fuzzer written in Go
Amass	15.4k	2018	2026-07-19	In-depth attack surface mapping and asset discovery

FULL INVENTORY — 48 CURATED TOOLS

ranked by GitHub adoption · 2026-10-23 census · non-GitHub tools listed without stars

TOOL	★STARS	CREATED	LAST PUSH	LICENSE / TIER
sherlock	94.7k	2018	2026-10-22 ✓	— hunt one username across 400+ social networks; people-OSINT in seconds. Used by OSINT investigators checking username presence across hundreds of platforms; the standard free account-discovery tool.
GHunt	19.7k	2020	2026-04-10	— investigate a Google account's public footprint (photos, reviews, services) from an email — for authorized OSINT; respect ToS. Used by OSINT investigators profiling Google accounts from public artifacts; the open alternative to commercial people-intel tools. (AGPL-3.0)
theHarvester	18k	2011	2026-10-20 ✓	— emails, subdomains, hosts and names from public sources — the OSINT starter kit. Used by pentesters in the recon phase harvesting emails, names and subdomains; the veteran free OSINT gatherer. (GPL-2.0)

TOOL	★STARS	CREATED	LAST PUSH	LICENSE / TIER
katana	17.7k	2021	2026-10-22 ✓	— next-generation crawler with headless-browser support for JavaScript-heavy applications. Used by bug hunters and pentesters crawling modern JS-heavy apps; the ProjectDiscovery successor to legacy crawlers in recon pipelines.
ffuf	16.9k	2018	2026-09-26 ✓	— the fast web fuzzer everyone uses for content, parameter and vhost discovery. Used by web pentesters as the de facto standard free web fuzzer.
Amass	15.4k	2018	2026-07-19	— deep attack-surface mapping: DNS enumeration, scraping, archives, APIs and permutations in one OWASP project. Used by recon teams and bug bounty hunters for deep subdomain enumeration; the OWASP project that anchors most serious attack-surface pipelines.
dirsearch	15k	2013	2026-10-20 ✓	— the 2013-vintage web path brute-forcer with an optional Rust native backend, wordlist transformations and resumable sessions. Used by web pentesters enumerating hidden paths and endpoints for over a decade; the classic Python scanner — the lineage anchor alongside ffuf and feroxbuster. (GPL-2.0)
subfinder	14.6k	2018	2026-10-21 ✓	— fast, passive subdomain discovery from dozens of sources; the standard first command of any engagement. Used by bug bounty hunters for fast passive subdomain discovery; the ProjectDiscovery staple of recon automation.
gobuster	14.2k	2014	2026-10-15 ✓	— the classic directory/DNS/vhost buster in Go; the tool feroxbuster and ffuf grew from. Used by pentesters for directory, DNS and vhost brute-forcing; the veteran free alternative to commercial content scanners.
bbot	10.7k	2022	2026-10-22 ✓	— recursive, modular OSINT/scanning framework — spider the whole attack surface with one command. Used by attack-surface teams running modular, recursive recon; the open-source framework rivaling commercial ASM discovery. (AGPL-3.0)
httpx	10.5k	2020	2026-10-21 ✓	— the HTTP prober: filter thousands of hosts by status, title, tech, CDN and TLS in a single pass. Used by bug bounty hunters triaging alive hosts from mass subdomain lists; the ProjectDiscovery prober in nearly every recon pipeline.
reconFTW	8.3k	2020	2026-09-26 ✓	— fully automated recon framework orchestrating ~100 external tools (subfinder, nuclei, nmap, gitleaks…) into one configurable pipeline with OSINT, cloud-enum and Azure-tenant stages. Used by recon teams running scheduled attack-surface sweeps without hand-rolling bash; the Docker-deployed recon automation standard. (MIT)
feroxbuster	8.1k	2020	2026-10-15 ✓	— fast recursive content discovery in Rust with great heuristics and recursion handling. Used by web pentesters for fast recursive content discovery; the Rust-based favorite alongside ffuf and gobuster.
wfuzz	6.6k	2014	2026-01-21	— the web fuzzer that replaces any part of a request with a payload — parameters, headers, paths, verbs. Used by web pentesters fuzzing any part of an HTTP request; the classic free fuzzer predating ffuf. (GPL-2.0)
naabu	6.3k	2020	2026-10-21 ✓	— fast, SYN-based port scanner built to be pipelined, not watched. Used by bug bounty hunters for SYN port scanning; the ProjectDiscovery port scanner in recon pipelines.
recon-ng	6k	2019	2026-10-05 ✓	— the other recon framework: fully modular, database-backed web recon with a Metasploit-style console. Used by pentesters running structured recon workflows; the Metasploit-style framework for the recon phase. (GPL-3.0)
EyeWitness	5.9k	2014	2026-01-05	— screenshots, headers and key info from web servers during authorized recon passes. Used by pentesters screenshotting and triaging web servers in bulk; the standard free recon triage tool. (GPL-3.0)

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hakrawler	5.2k	2019	2026-08-05	— lightweight Go crawler that eats URLs from stdin and emits discovered endpoints and JavaScript file locations up to a configurable depth. Used by bug bounty hunters seeding recon pipelines from quick crawls; hakluke's pipeline-friendly staple, packaged in Kali. (GPL-3.0)
gau	5.1k	2020	2026-10-12 ✓	— fetch URLs indexed by AlienVault OTX, the Wayback Machine and Common Crawl. Used by bug bounty hunters pulling all known URLs from public archives; the free fetcher that seeds most recon pipelines.
massdns	3.7k	2016	2026-09-27 ✓	— high-performance DNS stub resolver for bulk subdomain brute-forcing at scale. Used by recon pipelines resolving millions of subdomains; the free high-performance resolver no commercial tool beats on price. (GPL-3.0)
ParamSpider	3.2k	2020	2026-03-07	— mines archived URLs and parameters from the Wayback Machine to seed injection testing. Used by bug hunters mining hidden parameters from archives; the free parameter-mining step before injection testing.
dnsrecon	3.1k	2010	2026-10-12 ✓	— DNS enumeration workhorse: records, zone transfers, reverse lookups and subdomain brute-forcing. Used by pentesters enumerating DNS records and zone transfers; the veteran free DNS enumeration tool. (GPL-2.0)
FinalRecon	3k	2019	2026-06-01	— all-in-one web recon: headers, whois, SSL, DNS, subdomains, ports, directories and traceroute in a single modular run. Used by pentesters running a fast first-pass recon sweep before deep-dive tooling; the modular Python alternative to juggling ten single-purpose scripts. (MIT)
dnsx	2.9k	2020	2026-10-21 ✓	— multi-purpose DNS toolkit: reverse lookups, wildcard detection, response filtering. Used by recon teams for DNS querying and reverse lookups at scale; the ProjectDiscovery DNS multitool.
waymore	2.8k	2022	2026-06-11	— pull way more from the Wayback Machine: full responses, not just URLs. Used by bug hunters mining the Wayback Machine deeply for hidden endpoints and parameters; the successor to gau for archive URL intel.
CloakQuest3r	2.3k	2023	2026-01-06	— unmask the real origin IP behind Cloudflare and similar CDNs using historical DNS, SSL certificates and subdomain correlation. Used by security teams verifying true origin exposure before hardening allowlists; the open-source alternative to commercial CDN-unmasking services. (MIT)
subjack	2.1k	2017	2026-10-21 ✓	— subdomain-takeover scanner that flags dangling CNAMEs, stale NS delegations, orphaned A records and SPF/MX/SRV vectors across large concurrent domain lists. Used by bug bounty hunters and asset teams hunting hijackable subdomains before attackers do; the veteran takeover checker that still anchors this bug class. (MIT)
JARM	1.3k	2020	2026-08-13	— active TLS server fingerprint: identifies servers behind CDNs from their handshake behavior. Used by CTI analysts identifying TLS server infrastructure; the free passive fingerprint actively used in threat research. (BSD-3-Clause)
VHostScan	1.3k	2017	2025-08-18 ⌛	— enumerates virtual hosts on a shared IP — discover the neighbors your target lives with. Used by pentesters discovering virtual hosts on shared infrastructure; a focused free tool for shared-hosting engagements. (GPL-3.0)
Awesome Censys Queries	1.2k	2022	2026-07-20	— a curated corpus of Censys search queries for internet-wide recon. Used by CTI analysts running certified Censys hunting; the community cookbook for asset-search queries. (CC-BY-4.0, curated list)
Recog	796	2013	2026-10-12 ✓	— the fingerprint database behind Metasploit and Nexpose: service banners mapped to OS and product families. Used by fingerprinting tool maintainers for service identification; the open database behind Metasploit and Rapid7 tooling. (BSD-3-Clause)

TOOL	★STARS	CREATED	LAST PUSH	LICENSE / TIER
ARL-Next	469	2026	2026-10-22 ✓	— attack-surface reconnaissance platform combining subdomain enumeration, port scanning, fingerprinting and a nuclei PoC pipeline with task scheduling. Used by attack-surface teams running scheduled recon over large asset lists; the actively maintained continuation of the ARL recon platform. (GPL-3.0)
lit-bb-hack-tools	395	2021	2026-10-22 ✓	— monorepo of 26 small stdin/stdout CLI utilities that reshape and pivot recon output — subdomain-takeover checks, redirect chains, JS and parameter mining. Used by bug bounty hunters gluing tool outputs into pipelines; the unix-philosophy companion to monolithic recon suites. (GPL-3.0)
nerva	370	2026	2026-10-21 ✓	— high-performance service fingerprinting CLI identifying 170+ protocols on TCP, UDP and SCTP with safe misconfiguration checks. Used by recon teams fingerprinting services at scale without credentials; Praetorian's open-source protocol identification engine. (Apache-2.0)
DorkEye	154	2025	2026-10-21 ✓	— OSINT dork pipeline: email, subdomain and people discovery through structured query automation. Used by bug hunters running Google dorks via SearX; the free web-based dork launcher. (MIT)
reKover	52	2026	2026-10-21 ✓	— stealth hybrid URL mapper merging wayback-machine history with wordlist probing to recover hidden and forgotten paths. Used by bug bounty hunters recovering forgotten endpoints and legacy paths; the zero-dependency bash alternative to heavy content-discovery suites. (MIT per README)
AtDork	49	2026	2026-10-21 ✓	— multi-engine Google-dork scraper with categorized GHDB output for authorized reconnaissance. Used by bug bounty hunters automating Google dorking for exposed targets; the free dork engine for recon. (MIT)
BloodRecon	22	2025	2026-10-16 ✓	— automated recon pipeline that chains subdomain discovery, JavaScript endpoint extraction and a nuclei handoff with Telegram notifications. Used by bug bounty hunters automating the recon-to-scan handoff; the one-command recon pipeline for bounty workflows. (MIT)
Dork	10	2026	2026-08-21	— curated Google-dork payload library for cloud, AI, SaaS and IoT reconnaissance. Used by recon teams pulling tested dorks per target class; the categorized dork corpus for scoped discovery. (MIT)
DorkCraft	9	2026	2026-10-12 ✓	— rule-based dork generator: translates intent into search queries deterministically, zero AI, zero outbound calls. Used by recon practitioners bulk-running dork queries; the open dork-scanning alternative to paid search tooling. (MIT)
recon	5	2026	2026-10-21 ✓	— passive domain-intelligence framework with per-phase structured output for tech-stack and email-security audits. Used by auditors assembling passive domain profiles without touching the target; the structured-output recon framework for assessment prep. (Apache-2.0)
Dorker	—	2026	2026-10-22 ✓	— cross-platform multi-engine Google-dork CLI with per-engine query translation and scoped validation. Used by OSINT hunters running one dork across multiple engines; the dork translator for cross-engine reconnaissance. (Apache-2.0)
DorkIntel	—	2026	2026-10-21 ✓	— client-side library of 162 categorized Google dorks for intelligence dashboards. Used by OSINT tool builders embedding dork queries in dashboards; the embeddable dork dataset for client-side intel tooling. (MIT)
CeWL	—	—	—	— custom wordlist generation by spidering target sites — the content-aware dictionary for authorized assessments. Used by pentesters building custom wordlists from target sites for password audits; the standard free custom-wordlist spider. (GPL-3.0)
DNSdumpster	—	—	—	— visual DNS reconnaissance: subdomains, MX, and infrastructure maps from public records. Used by beginners and quick-recon tasks for visual DNS mapping; the free web tool that kickstarts attack-surface discovery. (free service)

TOOL	★STARS	CREATED	LAST PUSH	LICENSE / TIER
Maltego CE	—	—	—	— the standard OSINT graphing tool for entity-relationship investigation; free community edition. Used by OSINT analysts and investigators for link analysis; the free community edition of the commercial Maltego. (free tier)
Merklemap	—	—	—	— subdomain discovery through certificate-transparency logs; billions of entries, searchable. Used by recon teams searching Certificate Transparency for subdomains; the free CT search joining crt.sh-style tooling. (free service)
WiGLE	—	—	—	— the wireless network mapping archive; queries by BSSID/SSID across millions of observed networks. Used by wireless OSINT researchers mapping networks worldwide; the free wardriving database with no commercial equal. (free service)